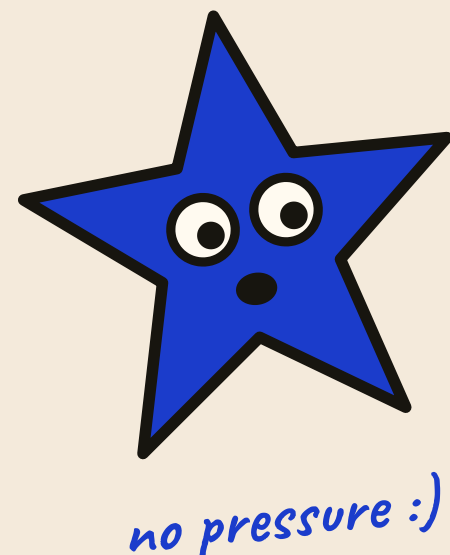


10 hooks i actually posted



not stolen from a viral thread. pulled from 29 of my own linkedin posts, ranked by what people actually reacted to. each one comes with a template to steal and a 5 minute task.

10 HOOKS

29 REAL POSTS

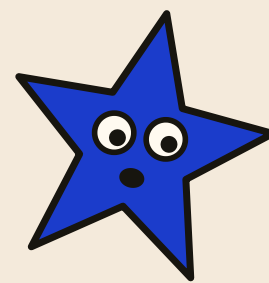
5 MIN EACH

ZERO “AGREE?” AT THE END

what's inside

ranked by reactions, best first. yes, even the ones that flopped.

- | | |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|
| ① the flex with a twist | ⑥ the withheld answer |
| ② the confession | ⑦ the backfire |
| ③ the receipt | ⑧ the one-liner |
| ④ the “how did i” | ⑨ the hot take |
| ⑤ the fake-out | ⑩ the mirror |



your hook has one job

make them read line two. not go viral, not sound smart. just line two.

1 two lines, then a gap

line 1 is the tension, line 2 is the promise. keep it under ~15 words before “see more” cuts you off, and make line 1 fit on one phone line.

2 who + problem + hold back

name who it's for, touch a problem they actually have, and don't hand over the answer in the hook.

3 write 5, post 1

write the same hook 5 ways, each in a different style from this guide. post the one that makes *you* want to read the next line.

~3x

what my own data told me: posts about my actual life got 105 to 175 reactions. my “here are 5 tips” posts got 36 to 52.

(yes i checked. it hurt a little.)

so every hook in here starts with something that happened to you. not “you should”.

the flex with a twist

say the impressive thing, then undercut it straight away. the gap between the two lines is the hook.



gaurav sharma

my real post, word for word

i was the president of Finance & Investment Cell, Aryabhata College

and now my career is complete opposite of it

...see more

175 REACTIONS

14 COMMENTS

why it works

- line 1 is proof, so nobody scrolls past thinking you're a nobody
- line 2 opens a question: wait, why did he leave?
- the flex feels earned because the post is about walking away from it

WATCH OUT if the twist never comes, it's just a brag with extra steps.

steal the template

i was **the impressive thing you used to**

be

and now i **do the complete opposite**

your turn

5 MIN

write down 3 titles, roles or wins you had that have nothing to do with your work today. pick the one people would least expect from you. that's line 1.

the confession

open on the feeling you'd normally hide. people stop for the emotion and stay for the story.

**gaurav sharma**

my real post, word for word

seeing my mother crying was not on the bucket list gang
but your boy has finally moved out..

...see more

171 REACTIONS

33 COMMENTS

why it works

- line 1 is a scene, not a claim. you can literally see it
- “gang” and “your boy” stop it from getting too heavy
- line 2 says what actually happened, so nobody feels tricked

WATCH OUT don't fake the feeling. people can smell a manufactured tear from the feed.

steal the template

the emotional moment you didn't plan

for

but the big thing you actually did

your turn

5 MIN

think of the last big decision you made. what was the hardest moment around it, the one you'd skip if you told the story at a party? start there.

CREDIBILITY

the receipt

one exact number does more than a paragraph of adjectives. the more precise, the more people believe it.



gaurav sharma
my real post, word for word

in the month of july i spent 1,15,643
to be precise

...see more

155 REACTIONS

28 COMMENTS

why it works

- 1,15,643 is not a round number, so it reads as true
- money is the one topic everyone reads twice
- “to be precise” is a tiny joke. it sounds like a person, not a report

WATCH OUT the number needs a story behind it.
mine was moving out and buying my brother a phone.

steal the template

in **a time period** i **spent / sent / lost /**
made **an exact, unrounded number**
a 3 word aside

your turn 5 MIN

open your bank app, screen time, calendar or sent folder. find one number from last month that surprised you. don't round it.

the “how did i”

ask the question people would DM you anyway, then answer it in the post. it's a promise dressed up as a question.



gaurav sharma

my real post, word for word

how as a 21 year old i managed
to move out from my house?

...see more

141 REACTIONS

30 COMMENTS

why it works

- it's specific: an age, an action, a result
- it promises a how, so people expect steps and stay for them
- 30 comments, because everyone had their own version to share

WATCH OUT you have to actually give the how. a question hook with a vague answer burns trust fast.

steal the template

how as a **who you were back then** i
managed
to **the thing people think is hard**?

your turn

5 MIN

what's one thing people keep asking you “how did you do that?” about? write the question exactly the way they ask it.

the fake-out

say something that sounds like one thing, then flip it in the very next line.



gaurav sharma

my real post, word for word

i hate posting on linkedin nowadays!!
and it's not what you think

...see more

118 REACTIONS

11 COMMENTS

also worked: “i am hiring, actually not for my company!” 105 reactions · 27 comments

why it works

- line 1 gives a tiny “wait, what?”
- line 2 admits there's a twist, so people tap to get it
- it only works when the flip is honest

WATCH OUT the real reason has to be good. if the twist is boring, the fake-out feels like a lie.

steal the template

i **a strong statement nobody expects**
from you
and it's not what you think

your turn

5 MIN

finish “i hate ___” three different ways. keep the one where the real reason is the opposite of what people will assume.

the withheld answer

tell them there IS an answer. just don't give it in line 1.



gaurav sharma

my real post, word for word

i inherited the one thing
i used to hate about my dad

...see more

107 REACTIONS

27 COMMENTS

why it works

- “the one thing” opens a loop the brain wants to close
- everyone has a thing they swore they'd never become
- the answer lands right after “see more”, so they have to tap

WATCH OUT pay it off fast. if the answer is buried at the bottom, people leave.

steal the template

i **inherited / copied / became** the one thing
i used to **hate / judge / laugh at** about **a person**

your turn

5 MIN

who's the person you swore you'd never become? what's one habit of theirs you have now? that's your post.

the backfire

tell them the plan went wrong. people trust the person who admits it way more than the one who only posts wins.



gaurav sharma

my real post, word for word

moving out actually backfired on me
because i didn't see coming these things

...see more

80 REACTIONS

11 COMMENTS

why it works

- it's the sequel to a win they already saw, so they're invested
- “backfired” is one strong, simple word
- an honest update beats a polished highlight reel

WATCH OUT don't end in self pity. end with what you're changing. mine was timeblocking.

steal the template

a decision you were proud of actually
backfired on me
because **what you didn't see coming**

your turn

5 MIN

pick something you posted about proudly 1 to 3 months ago. what went wrong after?
write the update nobody asked for.

PHOTO + ONE LINE

the one-liner

one line, one photo. no lesson, no list. it's a vibe, and vibes get comments.


gaurav sharma

my real post, word for word

i was staring the ceiling to get some idea
i think need to stare more.

...see more

73 REACTIONS

14 COMMENTS

also worked: “Hardest question to answer ‘Aap kartey kya ho?’” 45 reactions · 5 comments

why it works

- it takes 2 seconds, so almost everyone finishes it
- the photo does half the work
- it reminds people you're a person, not a content machine

steal the template

a real, slightly silly thing you're doing

right now

one line joke about it

WATCH OUT it's a breather, not a strategy. use it between your big posts, not instead of them.

your turn

5 MIN

take one honest photo of where you're working today. write one line about it. post it before you overthink it.

COUNTER-NARRATIVE

the hot take

say the opposite of what everyone in your space keeps repeating.
only if you actually believe it.



gaurav sharma
my real post, word for word

ai will not make you rich
at least in 2026

...see more

52 REACTIONS

1 COMMENT

why it works

- it argues with the feed, and that stops the scroll
- “at least in 2026” makes it a sharp claim, not a rant
- it tells people what you stand for

WATCH OUT honest data: my hot takes got way fewer comments than my stories. people nod and scroll. use them to take a stand, not for reach.

steal the template

the popular belief in your space will
not **the promise everyone makes**
at least **the condition that makes you**
right

your turn 5 MIN

write down the advice in your industry you're most tired of hearing. now write, in one line, what you'd say instead.

SAY WHAT THEY'RE THINKING

the mirror

describe their problem better than they could. they feel seen before they know what you're offering.



gaurav sharma
my real post, word for word

you're posting daily, building daily, grinding daily
and still can't tell if you're actually moving forward

...see more

45 REACTIONS

1 COMMENT

why it works

- daily, daily, daily is rhythm. you feel the tiredness
- it names the reader without saying “if you're a creator”
- the next line is “that was me”, so it turns into a story

steal the template

you're **doing X** daily, **doing Y** daily
and still **the frustration they won't say**
out loud

WATCH OUT my lowest one here, and i think i know why: the rest of the post read like advice. the mirror only works if you step into it too.

your turn 5 MIN

collect the exact words your people use when they complain. DMs, comments, calls. use their words in line 1, not yours.

now you. write 5.

pick the next post you're going to write. write its hook 5 ways, one style each. post the one that makes you want to read line two. print this, or just screenshot it and scribble.

THE CONFESSION

line 1 _____

line 2 _____

THE RECEIPT

line 1 _____

line 2 _____

THE FAKE-OUT

line 1 _____

line 2 _____

THE WITHHELD ANSWER

line 1 _____

line 2 _____

THE MIRROR

line 1 _____

line 2 _____

the 30 second check

- ☐ line 1 fits on one phone line

- ☐ under ~15 words before “see more”

- ☐ there's a real number, name or place in it

- ☐ i'd still stand by it if nobody reacted

- ☐ if i pasted it on a stranger's profile, it wouldn't make sense.
(that's how you know it's yours)

all 5 ticked? post it. missing one? fix line 1, not the whole post.

the one i left out

fear hooks. “if you don't use AI you'll be unemployable in 2 years.” they work.
they also turn you into that guy.

i'd rather be the guy who spent 1,15,643 in july and told you exactly where it went.

THAT'S IT. GO POST.

stuck on what your story even is?



hooks are easy once you know what you stand for. if you don't yet, i made a tiny thing for that.

EIGHT HONEST QUESTIONS

why do you want a personal brand?

answer eight questions in your own words and walk away with one sentence you can actually post against. no sign up, no email, nothing saved.

take the 8 questions

personal-branding-questionnaire.vercel.app

if this helped, send it to one friend who keeps saying

"i'll start posting from monday"

say hi on linkedin · [linkedin.com/in/nowaygaurav](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nowaygaurav)

the numbers are reactions and comments on 29 of my posts (#46 to #100 of my 365 day challenge), checked on 2026-09-23. small sample, real numbers. test your own, that's the whole point. hook types adapted from The LinkedIn Lab (Amney Mounir & Karina), Episode 8.